

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 4-6

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

C	L	O	S	E
W	R	I	T	E

Ladder 2

S	P	A	R	E
S	W	I	F	T

Ladder 3

C	H	E	E	R
T	R	A	C	K

Ladder 4

B	R	U	S	H
G	R	A	S	S

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

C	L	O	S	E
C	H	O	S	E
W	H	O	S	E
W	H	O	L	E
W	H	I	L	E
W	H	I	T	E
W	R	I	T	E

Ladder 2

S	P	A	R	E
S	H	A	R	E
S	H	O	R	E
S	H	O	R	T
S	H	I	R	T
S	H	I	F	T
S	W	I	F	T

Ladder 3

C	H	E	E	R
C	H	E	E	K
C	H	E	C	K
C	H	I	C	K
T	H	I	C	K
T	R	I	C	K
T	R	A	C	K

Ladder 4

B	R	U	S	H
C	R	U	S	H
C	R	A	S	H
C	L	A	S	H
C	L	A	S	S
G	L	A	S	S
G	R	A	S	S